

Figure 2.10 *Between Pasa Band and Dahane Nawrak, cruciform interior of a defensive structure. From Herberg 1982: fig. 6.*

As described in the preceding chapters, the early Shansabanis and other Ghuris spanned the continuum between nomadism and sedentism, with many groups engaging in seasonal transhumance combined with spot agriculture. Modern Taimani and Firozkohi nomads inhabiting the areas immediately north and south of the Hari Rud (east of Herat) provide illustrative parallels in broad contours,[43] which can inform historical understandings of transhumant and nomadic–pastoralist groups such as the pre-imperial Shansabanis and their fellow Ghuris.

The southern Taimanis' summer shelters of rectangular black tents (Figure 2.11), made of willow poles and woven goat hair coverings (*palas*), required no specialized architectural skill per se. Although it is noteworthy that their tents tend to mimic winter village dwellings, and the tent coverings are traditionally woven by women. By contrast, the Firozkohis' yurts (Figure 2.12) were heavier and laborious to erect, resulting in a more expensive dwelling that also required camel or other large-scale transport. Given the yurt's characteristics as a dwelling type, it was used by groups with short migration circuits, and only in regions within the circulatory patterns of artisans skilled in crafting their specialized wood frames.[44]

All in all, the lifeways described above appear to preclude the need for coordinated projects of immovable architecture,[45] such as dwelling towers and fortifications interconnecting vast swaths of land. Transhumant and nomadic–pastoralist existences instead require principal concentrations of time, energy and resources upon moveable dwellings, animal hus-